

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Ergonomics researcher Tomas Bergqvist reports that office workers who replaced seated workstations with standing desks expended measurably more energy over an eight-hour day. Bergqvist frames the result as evidence that workplace design can contribute meaningfully to daily energy expenditure without requiring workers to set aside additional time for exercise.

Text 2

Physiologist Naledi Motaung does not question the measurements, which she describes as carefully collected and consistent with earlier work. She notes, however, that the additional expenditure amounts to roughly eight calories per hour -- about the energy contained in a quarter of an apple. Framing an effect of that magnitude as a meaningful contribution to health, Motaung argues, risks diverting attention from interventions with substantially larger effects.

Based on the texts, how would Motaung (Text 2) most likely respond to Bergqvist's framing of his results in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that Bergqvist's measurements were collected using equipment insufficiently sensitive to detect small changes in energy expenditure.
- B: By contending that standing desks increase energy expenditure only among workers who were already physically active outside of work.
- C: By granting that the effect Bergqvist measured is real while disputing that an effect of its size deserves the significance he assigns it.
- D: By proposing that workplace design should be evaluated according to worker comfort rather than according to any health outcome.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Motaung explicitly says she "does not question the measurements." Trick: separate disputing the data from disputing its importance. When Text 2 accepts the number but converts it into something trivial (a quarter of an apple), the disagreement is about magnitude, not accuracy.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Forest ecologist Aina Halvorsen argues that old-growth stands should be protected because of the carbon they store. Trees that have grown for centuries hold quantities of carbon in trunk and soil that replanted forests take generations to match, and Halvorsen calculates that logging such stands releases more carbon than decades of subsequent regrowth can recover.

Text 2

Cultural geographer Peter Yeung also opposes logging in old-growth stands, though on different grounds. For several Indigenous communities in the region, particular stands function as sites of ceremony and as reference points in oral histories that locate events by describing named trees. Yeung argues that these relationships cannot be transferred to a replanted forest, whatever its eventual carbon content.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between the two arguments?

- A: The two authors reach opposite conclusions about old-growth logging on the basis of the same body of evidence.
- B: Halvorsen provides empirical support for a claim that Yeung had earlier advanced on theoretical grounds.
- C: Yeung identifies a flaw in Halvorsen's carbon calculations and proposes a corrected method for performing them.
- D: The two authors advocate the same policy but justify it by appealing to entirely different kinds of value.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Yeung says "also opposes... though on different grounds." Trick: agreement on the conclusion plus difference in the reasoning is a distinct relationship from disagreement. Scan for whether the second author's verb is "opposes" (same side) or "disputes" (opposite side).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

In a study of undergraduate learning, education researcher Divya Raghunathan found that students who reviewed material at spaced intervals retained substantially more of it after six weeks than students who studied the same material in a single concentrated session. Raghunathan recommends that spaced review be built into course design across subjects.

Text 2

Learning scientist Anders Falk observes that the advantage of spaced review has been demonstrated most reliably for material composed of discrete items -- vocabulary, formulas, anatomical terms. In studies involving extended argumentative texts, where comprehension depends on holding many elements in mind simultaneously, the advantage narrows considerably and in some designs disappears altogether.

Based on the texts, how would Falk (Text 2) most likely respond to Raghunathan's recommendation in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that the retention gains Raghunathan measured would disappear entirely if students were tested after a longer interval.
- B: By noting that the benefit is well established for some kinds of material but much weaker for others, so applying it across all subjects may not be warranted.
- C: By suggesting that Raghunathan's students were unrepresentative of undergraduates at other institutions.
- D: By claiming that concentrated study sessions produce better outcomes than spaced review for nearly all types of academic material.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Falk never denies the effect; he narrows where it holds. Trick: a scope restriction says "true for X, not for Y." Watch for the phrase "most reliably for," which quietly implies "less reliably elsewhere" and undercuts a blanket recommendation.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Architectural historian Colin Farrow notes that timber-framed buildings constructed in England before 1700 have in many cases stood for three centuries or more with only routine maintenance. He attributes this longevity to the quality of slow-grown oak available at the time and to joinery techniques that allowed frames to flex rather than crack under settlement.

Text 2

Preservation engineer Bilal Nasser points out that the buildings available for Farrow to examine are, by definition, the ones that did not fall down. Parish records from the same period document large numbers of timber structures that collapsed, burned, or were demolished as unsound within a few decades of construction. The surviving stock, Nasser argues, tells us about the best construction of the period rather than the typical.

Based on the texts, how would Nasser (Text 2) most likely respond to Farrow's explanation in Text 1?

- A: By disputing Farrow's claim that oak grown before 1700 possessed structural properties superior to those of modern timber.
- B: By arguing that Farrow's conclusions rest on a sample consisting only of successful cases, which cannot support claims about construction practice generally.
- C: By contending that parish records from the period are too fragmentary to support any conclusions about historical building practices.
- D: By asserting that flexible joinery techniques were introduced considerably later than Farrow's account suggests.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: "The ones that did not fall down" is survivorship bias in plain language. Trick: when Text 2 points out that the sample was filtered by the very outcome under study, the objection is about what the sample can support, not about whether the surviving examples are well built.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Applied linguist Marisol Iglesias reports that machine translation now handles routine travel, commerce, and correspondence with accuracy sufficient for most practical purposes. Learners who once spent years acquiring a second language for such tasks, she notes, can accomplish them immediately with a phone, and enrollment in introductory language courses has declined accordingly.

Text 2

Language educator Hiroshi Tanabe accepts Iglesias's account of the technology's capabilities and of enrollment trends. He argues nonetheless that the purpose of language study was never primarily transactional. Learning a language restructures how a person attends to their own speech and grants access to a community from the inside rather than through an intermediary, and no translation tool, however accurate, delivers either.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between the two texts?

- A: Tanabe accepts Iglesias's factual claims but disputes the standard by which the value of language study should be judged.
- B: Tanabe and Iglesias disagree about whether enrollment in language courses has in fact declined.
- C: Tanabe presents evidence that machine translation is less accurate than Iglesias's account suggests.
- D: Iglesias and Tanabe agree that language instruction should be redesigned around the capabilities of new technology.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Tanabe "accepts Iglesias's account" of both the technology and the enrollment data. Trick: when Text 2 concedes every fact and still disagrees, the dispute has to be about values or standards. Eliminate any option that puts them at odds over data.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Public health researcher Elin Sorensen surveyed participants in organized cold-water swimming groups and found that a large majority reported improved mood in the hours following immersion. Sorensen notes that the reports were consistent across age groups and seasons but that her study design could not identify what produced the effect.

Text 2

Physiologist Rajiv Kapoor has measured circulating norepinephrine in swimmers before and after cold immersion, documenting increases of several hundred percent that persist for roughly an hour. Norepinephrine is closely associated with alertness and elevated mood, and Kapoor proposes that the acute stress of cold exposure triggers a hormonal response that outlasts the exposure itself.

Based on the texts, what is the relationship between Text 1 and Text 2?

- A: Text 2 presents evidence that contradicts the mood improvements documented in Text 1.
- B: Text 2 offers a physiological explanation for an effect that Text 1 documented but left unexplained.
- C: Text 2 argues that the participants in Text 1 were unusually susceptible to the effects of cold exposure.
- D: Text 2 replicates the study described in Text 1 using a substantially larger group of participants.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Text 1 says outright that its design "could not identify what produced the effect," and Text 2 supplies exactly that. Trick: when Text 1 names a gap in its own account, check whether Text 2 fills it. Complementary, not conflicting.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Archaeologist Nuria Vidal excavated a coastal settlement where obsidian from a source three hundred kilometers inland appears in nearly every household deposit. Vidal interprets the distribution as evidence of an established trade network, arguing that material so widely and evenly distributed must have arrived through regular exchange rather than sporadic acquisition.

Text 2

Archaeologist Peter Oduya notes that even distribution across households is equally consistent with a different scenario: a single large acquisition, obtained perhaps through one expedition or one act of gift-giving, subsequently shared out among households according to local conventions of redistribution. Distinguishing the two, Oduya argues, requires dating individual pieces rather than mapping their spread.

Based on the texts, how would Oduya (Text 2) most likely respond to Vidal's interpretation in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that the obsidian at the site originated from a source considerably closer than Vidal has proposed.
- B: By pointing out that the same distribution pattern would also be produced by a scenario involving no ongoing trade at all.
- C: By claiming that Vidal's excavation methods were inadequate to establish the contents of household deposits.
- D: By contending that redistribution among households was uncommon in coastal settlements of this period.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Oduya says the evidence is "equally consistent with a different scenario." Trick: this is an underdetermination objection -- the data do not discriminate between explanations. He accepts the pattern Vidal found and denies that it settles the question.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Urban policy analyst Grace Mwangi advocates replacing municipal parking minimums with a system in which developers pay a per-space fee into a transit fund. The arrangement, she argues, would let the market determine how much parking a building actually requires while directing revenue toward alternatives to driving.

Text 2

Planning historian Federico Salas notes that fee-in-lieu parking systems of essentially this design operated in more than forty American cities between 1965 and 1990. In most, the fee was set well below the cost of constructing a space, so developers paid it as a matter of course and transit funds accumulated far more slowly than projected. Salas argues that the design's weakness lies in the political difficulty of setting the fee high enough to matter.

Based on the texts, how would Salas (Text 2) most likely respond to Mwangi's proposal in Text 1?

- A: By claiming that transit funding should be raised through general taxation rather than through development fees.
- B: By arguing that parking minimums produce better urban outcomes than any market-based alternative.
- C: By observing that the approach has an extensive prior history in which its central mechanism repeatedly failed for a predictable reason.
- D: By disputing Mwangi's assumption that developers respond to price signals when making construction decisions.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Salas's move is historical: this was tried in forty cities. Trick: when Text 2 dates a proposal to the past, the objection is that it has an empirical track record, not that it is theoretically unsound. Note he identifies why it failed -- the fee was set too low -- rather than rejecting the mechanism itself.

END QUESTION



QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Educational technologist Sunil Barot evaluated a tablet-based mathematics program introduced in twelve primary schools. Over a single term, classes using the program improved on standardized assessments by margins that Barot describes as among the largest he has recorded for any classroom intervention.

Text 2

Researcher Claudia Mensing followed nine of the same schools for three additional years. The initial advantage narrowed in the second year and was statistically indistinguishable from zero by the third. Mensing attributes the pattern to novelty: engagement with an unfamiliar device is high at first and declines as the device becomes ordinary, a trajectory documented for classroom technologies since the introduction of film projectors.

Based on the texts, how would Mensing (Text 2) most likely characterize the result reported in Text 1?

- A: As a finding that was never replicated by any independent research team.
- B: As evidence that tablet-based instruction is fundamentally unsuited to mathematics teaching.
- C: As an artifact of assessments that measured familiarity with the tablet rather than mathematical understanding.
- D: As an accurate measurement of a real but temporary effect that a longer study period reveals to be transient.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Mensing followed the same schools and does not dispute year one. Trick: the disagreement is about duration, not validity. When Text 2 extends the timeline and the effect decays, the correct answer says "real but temporary," not "wrong" or "never happened."

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Health economist Dieter Reinhardt ranked regional hospitals by thirty-day mortality following cardiac surgery and found a threefold difference between the highest- and lowest-performing institutions. Reinhardt argues that publishing such rankings gives patients information they currently lack and creates pressure on poorly performing hospitals to improve.

Text 2

Surgeon and researcher Amelia Fontaine notes that the hospitals at the bottom of Reinhardt's ranking are disproportionately those that accept transfers from smaller facilities, meaning their patients arrive sicker and later. Comparing raw mortality across institutions that receive systematically different patients, she argues, measures the composition of their caseloads at least as much as the quality of their care.

Based on the texts, how would Fontaine (Text 2) most likely respond to Reinhardt's proposal in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that patients rarely consult published quality information when selecting a hospital for surgery.
- B: By claiming that thirty-day mortality is too short an interval to capture the outcomes of cardiac surgery.
- C: By contending that the institutions being compared differ in ways that make raw mortality an unreliable indicator of the quality of their care.
- D: By asserting that competition between hospitals reduces rather than improves the overall quality of care.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Fontaine's point is that the groups being compared are not comparable. Trick: this is a case-mix objection. She does not say the mortality figures are miscounted; she says the comparison is unfair because the patient populations differ before treatment begins.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Environmental policy researcher Yara Nassif documents that municipal bans on thin single-use plastic bags reduced the number of such bags entering waste streams by more than eighty percent in the jurisdictions she studied. Nassif treats the reduction as evidence that targeted product bans can rapidly change consumer behavior.

Text 2

Materials analyst Owen Brackley agrees that thin bags largely disappeared. He notes, however, that purchases of thicker reusable plastic bags and of plastic bin liners rose sharply in the same jurisdictions, and that because these products contain several times more plastic per unit, total plastic tonnage in household waste declined only marginally and in two cities increased.

Based on the texts, how would Brackley (Text 2) most likely respond to Nassif's conclusion in Text 1?

- A: By pointing out that the reduction in one product was offset by increased consumption of substitutes, leaving the overall outcome largely unchanged.
- B: By arguing that consumer behavior is generally unresponsive to regulation of specific products.
- C: By claiming that thicker reusable bags are more environmentally damaging to manufacture than thin bags are to dispose of.
- D: By disputing Nassif's finding that thin single-use bags declined in the jurisdictions she examined.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Brackley "agrees that thin bags largely disappeared." Trick: substitution effects. When Text 2 accepts the narrow result and tracks what replaced it, the objection is that the measured success does not translate into the outcome that actually matters.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Ecologist Sofia Almeida used records from a national citizen-science platform to map the range of a declining butterfly species, concluding from the density of sightings that the species is now concentrated almost entirely near towns and along major roads.

Text 2

Biologist Kwabena Mensah notes that citizen-science records reflect where observers go, not only where organisms are. Volunteers are overwhelmingly concentrated near settlements and accessible roads; remote terrain generates few records regardless of what lives there. A map built from such data, Mensah argues, describes the distribution of observers with considerable accuracy and the distribution of the species only approximately.

Based on the texts, how would Mensah (Text 2) most likely respond to Almeida's conclusion in Text 1?

- A: By claiming that roadside habitat is genuinely more favorable to the species than remote habitat is.
- B: By arguing that citizen scientists frequently misidentify the butterfly species in question.
- C: By contending that the species has declined more severely than Almeida's records indicate.
- D: By noting that the data source systematically underrepresents areas where few observers travel, so the apparent concentration may be an artifact of sampling.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: "Reflect where observers go, not only where organisms are." Trick: uneven sampling effort. The records are accurate individually; the map is distorted because the search was not spread evenly. That is a sampling artifact, not a misidentification problem.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Energy analyst Rina Kobayashi reports that installed renewable generating capacity in the region tripled over the past decade and argues that this expansion demonstrates the sector's readiness to displace fossil fuel generation at scale.

Text 2

Grid engineer Marcus Thorne observes that installed capacity describes what a system could produce under ideal conditions, not what it does produce. Because wind and solar operate well below nameplate capacity much of the time, actual generation from the region's renewables rose by roughly a third over the same period. Thorne argues that capacity figures are useful for planning but misleading as a measure of displacement achieved.

Based on the texts, how would Thorne (Text 2) most likely respond to Kobayashi's argument in Text 1?

- A: By contending that Kobayashi has relied on a measure that overstates the change she is trying to demonstrate.
- B: By arguing that fossil fuel generation cannot be displaced by renewable sources under any foreseeable conditions.
- C: By disputing Kobayashi's figures for the growth of installed renewable capacity in the region.
- D: By claiming that grid infrastructure limitations, rather than generating capacity, are the binding constraint on renewable expansion.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Capacity tripled; generation rose by a third. Trick: the two authors are measuring different things. When Text 2 distinguishes what a system "could produce" from what it "does produce," the objection is that the wrong metric was chosen, not that the number is false.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Conservation manager Lena Ostrowski argues that resources for controlling invasive species should be allocated according to how recently a species arrived, on the reasoning that recently introduced populations are smaller and more easily eradicated than long-established ones.

Text 2

Ecologist Femi Adebayo questions the category on which such prioritization rests. Species introduced centuries ago are now integral to the food webs in which they sit, while some native species, released from historical constraints, spread as aggressively as any introduced one. What matters for management, Adebayo argues, is the ecological damage a population is currently causing, a question that date of arrival answers only unreliably.

Based on the texts, how would Adebayo (Text 2) most likely respond to Ostrowski's proposal in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that eradication of recently arrived species is more difficult and expensive than Ostrowski suggests.
- B: By asserting that long-established introduced species should be eradicated with the same urgency as recent arrivals.
- C: By claiming that conservation resources are better directed toward habitat protection than toward species control of any kind.
- D: By contending that the classification Ostrowski uses to set priorities does not reliably track the outcome she is trying to prevent.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Adebayo "questions the category" itself. Trick: this is a definitional objection, one level deeper than a disagreement about priorities. He argues the sorting rule (date of arrival) does not line up with the thing anyone cares about (current damage).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Historian Beatriz Cardoso describes the Minangkabau of Sumatra, among whom property passes from mother to daughter, as a striking exception to the patrilineal inheritance systems that she characterizes as the historical norm across agrarian societies.

Text 2

Anthropologist Ravi Deshmukh has compiled inheritance practices for four hundred and sixty documented agrarian societies. Matrilineal transmission of land appears in roughly a fifth of them, concentrated but by no means confined to Southeast Asia and parts of West Africa. Deshmukh argues that the impression of rarity derives from the disproportionate attention historians have given to a small number of state societies whose legal codes happened to survive.

Based on the texts, how would Deshmukh (Text 2) most likely respond to Cardoso's characterization in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that the Minangkabau system operates differently from the way Cardoso has described it.
- B: By claiming that patrilineal inheritance produces more stable landholding patterns than matrilineal inheritance does.
- C: By contending that inheritance practices in agrarian societies cannot be reliably documented from surviving records.
- D: By presenting evidence that the practice Cardoso treats as exceptional is considerably more widespread than her framing implies.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: One in five is not an exception. Trick: Text 2 attacks the framing "rare" by widening the sample, and then explains why the mistaken impression arose (surviving legal codes skew the record). The Minangkabau facts themselves are never in dispute.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Oceanographer Ingrid Bauer has documented that rivers transport large quantities of plastic waste into coastal waters, with ten river systems accounting for a substantial share of the total. Bauer argues that intercepting plastic at river mouths represents the most efficient available intervention.

Text 2

Marine scientist Diego Ferrari does not dispute that rivers deliver plastic to the ocean. Surveys of the accumulated debris in the largest offshore gyre, however, find that by mass the great majority consists of fishing nets, lines, and floats, material that enters the water far from any river. Ferrari argues that river interception addresses a real pathway but not the dominant one.

Based on the texts, how would Ferrari (Text 2) most likely respond to Bauer's recommendation in Text 1?

- A: By disputing Bauer's finding that ten river systems account for a substantial share of riverborne plastic.
- B: By accepting that rivers contribute plastic to the ocean while arguing that a different source accounts for most of what accumulates there.
- C: By arguing that plastic waste in the ocean poses less ecological risk than is generally supposed.
- D: By claiming that interception technology at river mouths has proven ineffective in field trials.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: "Does not dispute" plus "a real pathway but not the dominant one." Trick: accepting a mechanism while denying it is the main one. The disagreement is about relative share, so look for an answer containing both the concession and the ranking.

END QUESTION



QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Agronomist Chidi Nwosu reports that a newly released wheat variety produced yields approximately thirty percent higher than the landraces it replaced across three seasons of trials, and recommends its adoption throughout the growing region.

Text 2

Agricultural systems researcher Hana Lindgren notes that the three trial seasons all received rainfall near the long-term average. The landraces the new variety replaced were selected over generations for performance in drought years, when they substantially outyield modern varieties bred for average conditions. A region that adopts the new variety exclusively, Lindgren argues, raises its expected harvest while increasing the severity of its worst harvests.

Based on the texts, how would Lindgren (Text 2) most likely respond to Nwosu's recommendation in Text 1?

- A: By identifying a cost of the change that Nwosu's trials, conducted under favorable conditions, were not positioned to reveal.
- B: By arguing that landraces outperform modern varieties under all growing conditions.
- C: By disputing the yield figures that Nwosu recorded during the three trial seasons.
- D: By claiming that farmers in the region would be unwilling to adopt an unfamiliar wheat variety.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Average rainfall in all three seasons is the tell. Trick: a tradeoff the test conditions could not expose. Lindgren accepts the yield gain and adds a hidden cost -- worse bad years -- so the answer must name the tradeoff, not deny the benefit.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Developmental psychologist Anneke Vos found that nine-month-old infants look longer at a display in which an object appears to pass through a solid barrier than at one in which it stops. Vos interprets the extended looking as evidence that infants hold expectations about the physical properties of solid objects and register violations of those expectations.

Text 2

Psychologist Jonas Alvarez has replicated the looking-time difference in three separate samples and regards the phenomenon as well established. He notes, however, that displays violating physical expectations are also more visually complex, involving additional motion and contour change. Longer looking may register perceptual novelty rather than conceptual surprise, and the two interpretations have not been separated experimentally.

Based on the texts, how would Alvarez (Text 2) most likely characterize Vos's interpretation in Text 1?

- A: As resting on a finding that has repeatedly failed to replicate in independent samples.
- B: As demonstrating that infants possess more sophisticated physical knowledge than Vos herself claims.
- C: As one of at least two available readings of a reliable finding, with no evidence yet distinguishing between them.
- D: As applicable to nine-month-old infants but not to infants at other stages of development.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Alvarez replicated it three times and calls it "well established." Trick: the data survive, the interpretation does not. When Text 2 confirms the result and offers a rival reading of the same result, the answer is about competing interpretations, not failed replication.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Political scientist Aurelie Chastain observes that across sixty democracies, countries with higher average levels of educational attainment record higher rates of voter participation. She concludes that expanding access to education is among the more reliable means of raising turnout.

Text 2

Methodologist Sanjay Iyer notes that within most of the same countries, the relationship between an individual's education and that individual's likelihood of voting is weak once income and age are accounted for. A pattern that holds between countries need not hold within them: national averages can track differences in electoral law, compulsory voting rules, and registration systems that have nothing to do with any particular voter's schooling.

Based on the texts, how would Iyer (Text 2) most likely respond to Chastain's conclusion in Text 1?

- A: By pointing out that a correlation observed between countries does not license a conclusion about individual voters.
- B: By arguing that voter turnout is a poor indicator of the health of a democratic system.
- C: By contending that income rather than education is the strongest predictor of national turnout rates.
- D: By disputing Chastain's measurement of average educational attainment across the sixty countries.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: "Between countries" versus "within them" is the whole objection. Trick: a group-level pattern need not hold at the individual level. Iyer accepts Chastain's cross-national correlation and denies it supports the individual-level policy claim she draws from it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Astrobiologist Camille Duflot argues that the detection of atmospheric methane alongside oxygen on an exoplanet would constitute strong evidence of biological activity, since the two gases react readily with one another and their simultaneous presence implies continuous replenishment of a kind that only life is known to sustain.

Text 2

Planetary chemist Anton Reiss maintains that no atmospheric signature can carry that weight on its own. Abiotic processes capable of generating both gases have been demonstrated in laboratory conditions, and the space of possible planetary chemistries is large enough that unfamiliar mechanisms should be expected. Reiss holds that a biological claim requires ruling out non-biological production for the specific planet in question, a demand no remote observation currently satisfies.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the disagreement between Duflot and Reiss?

- A: They disagree about what would have to be established before an observation could count as evidence of life.
- B: They disagree about whether methane and oxygen react with one another under planetary atmospheric conditions.
- C: They disagree about whether current telescopes are capable of detecting atmospheric gases on distant exoplanets.
- D: They disagree about whether life is likely to exist on planets outside the solar system.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Duflot sets a chemical threshold; Reiss sets an eliminative one. Trick: the dispute is about evidentiary standards -- what counts as proof -- not about the chemistry or the instruments. Both accept the gases react; they differ on what that licenses.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Housing economist Priya Venkataraman argues that rents in constrained metropolitan markets will fall only when the supply of housing expands substantially. Regulations that restrict rent increases in existing units, she contends, should be relaxed to encourage construction, since developers respond to expected returns.

Text 2

Urban sociologist Malik Osei accepts that the long-run solution to high rents is a larger housing stock. He argues, however, that construction on the required scale takes a decade or more, during which households displaced by rising rents lose the neighborhood networks and school placements that make relocation costly in ways rent statistics do not capture. Protections should therefore be maintained while supply expands, not removed to accelerate it.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between the two arguments?

- A: Venkataraman and Osei disagree about whether an expanded housing supply would reduce rents in the long run.
- B: The two authors agree on the eventual remedy but disagree about what should be done during the period before it takes effect.
- C: Osei presents data showing that construction rates are unaffected by the regulations Venkataraman would relax.
- D: Venkataraman addresses metropolitan housing markets while Osei is concerned exclusively with rural ones.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Osei "accepts that the long-run solution is a larger housing stock." Trick: agreement on the destination, disagreement on sequencing. When Text 2 concedes the endpoint and objects to the transition, look for an answer that separates long run from interim.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Soil scientist Hugo Marchetti reports that nitrogen fertilizer application increased maize yields across his trial plots, with each additional increment of nitrogen producing further gains. He recommends that farmers in the region raise application rates, which he characterizes as currently well below optimal.

Text 2

Agronomist Wei Chen notes that Marchetti's trials spanned application rates from twenty to one hundred and forty kilograms per hectare. Above roughly one hundred and sixty, the relationship inverts: excess nitrogen acidifies soil and impairs root uptake, and yields decline. The rising relationship Marchetti documents is the ascending portion of a curve that turns over beyond the range he tested.

Based on the texts, how would Chen (Text 2) most likely respond to Marchetti's recommendation in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that nitrogen fertilizer has no measurable effect on maize yields at any application rate.
- B: By disputing the yield measurements Marchetti recorded within his trial plots.
- C: By noting that the relationship Marchetti observed holds only within the range he tested and reverses beyond it.
- D: By contending that soil acidification is a more serious problem than reduced maize yields.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Marchetti tested up to 140; the curve turns at 160. Trick: a relationship valid inside the tested range does not extend past it. Chen accepts every data point and objects only to the extrapolation beyond where the data stop.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Epidemiologist Farida Haddad documents that recorded diagnoses of a particular autoimmune condition rose fourfold in the national registry between 1995 and 2020. Haddad treats the increase as evidence of a genuine rise in incidence and calls for investigation of environmental exposures that changed over the same period.

Text 2

Clinical researcher Tomas Ruiz notes that the diagnostic criteria for the condition were broadened twice during the period Haddad examines, and that a blood assay capable of detecting mild cases entered routine use in 2003. When Ruiz reapplies the 1995 criteria to case files from 2020, the resulting count is roughly one and a half times the 1995 figure rather than four times it.

Based on the texts, how would Ruiz (Text 2) most likely respond to Haddad's interpretation in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that environmental exposures could not plausibly affect the incidence of an autoimmune condition.
- B: By contending that the national registry omits a substantial number of diagnosed cases.
- C: By claiming that the broadened diagnostic criteria adopted during the period were clinically unjustified.
- D: By showing that much of the recorded increase reflects changes in how cases are identified rather than in how often they occur.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Ruiz reapplies the old criteria and the fourfold rise shrinks to one and a half. Trick: distinguish a change in the phenomenon from a change in the measuring instrument. Note he does not deny a real increase exists -- only that most of the recorded one is measurement.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Economic historian Robert Aldridge observes that every previous wave of automation, from mechanized weaving to containerized shipping, eliminated occupations while generating new ones in numbers that eventually exceeded the losses. He argues that this consistent historical pattern gives reason for confidence about the current wave.

Text 2

Labor economist Ingrid Sallinen does not contest Aldridge's account of the historical record. She observes that in each earlier episode, displaced workers moved into tasks requiring capacities the machines of that era lacked -- typically judgment, language, or fine perception. If a technology encroaches on those same capacities, the historical pattern loses the mechanism that produced it, and past outcomes stop serving as a guide.

Based on the texts, how would Sallinen (Text 2) most likely respond to Aldridge's argument in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that containerized shipping displaced substantially more workers than Aldridge acknowledges.
- B: By disputing his claim that earlier waves of automation generated more jobs than they eliminated.
- C: By accepting his account of past automation while arguing that the conditions responsible for those outcomes may not hold now.
- D: By contending that historical evidence is never relevant to predicting economic outcomes.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: "Does not contest Aldridge's account of the historical record." Trick: she accepts the past and denies the extrapolation, by naming the mechanism that made the pattern hold and arguing it may now be absent. Not a dispute about history, a dispute about whether history transfers.

END QUESTION



QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Occupational psychologist Ilse Brandt reports that workers scoring high on a standard burnout inventory show elevated rates of absence and turnover, and recommends that organizations screen with the inventory and offer reduced hours to those who score highly.

Text 2

Researcher Adaeze Okoro notes that the inventory sums two components that behave differently: exhaustion, which reduced hours reliably relieve, and disengagement, a loss of investment in the work itself, which reduced hours do not relieve and occasionally deepen. Because a single score can arise from either component, Okoro argues that the composite obscures the distinction on which the appropriate response depends.

Based on the texts, how would Okoro (Text 2) most likely respond to Brandt's recommendation in Text 1?

- A: By disputing the association Brandt reports between high inventory scores and rates of absence and turnover.
- B: By claiming that reduced hours worsen outcomes for the majority of workers who score highly on the inventory.
- C: By contending that organizations should not intervene in workers' experience of their jobs at all.
- D: By arguing that the measure Brandt relies on combines distinct conditions that call for different responses.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: One score, two conditions, one remedy that fits only one of them. Trick: Okoro attacks the construct rather than the correlation. She grants that high scorers have worse outcomes and argues the measure fuses cases whose treatment should differ.

END QUESTION